

No more naked scans

A new software for screening of travellers at the US airports will address the general public concern over full-body scanners

Google Credit Card!

The \$7 billion company gives its advertising customers a credit card to beef up competition in the cut-throat market

From monitor troubles and Linux issues to BlackBerry problems

Everyone needs help troubleshooting tech problems, and that's where we come in

An eyesore

My problem is that my display used to flicker all the time. To be more descriptive it would weave in patterns.

I first faced the problem while playing some games, but later on, the problem exists when I am just on desktop. Some of my friends told me that it is because of my monitor. I was using a LG 17 inch CRT monitor, so I bought a new Samsung 18.5 inch LCD monitor but the problem still persists. I have also removed my speakers from the computer table. I have even tried different Operating Systems like windows XP, Ubuntu, Windows 7 but I can't get rid of this problem. Please help

Partha Goswami

 Sounds like a graphics card problem. Try a new GPU and if you're using onboard display, get a GPU. Don't buy one, ask one of your friends to loan you one to test for a day. If the GPU fixes the problem, you will have to purchase one for yourself.

Crazy keyboards

Last year, I have purchased a Lenovo 38Q laptop running Windows Vista. The problem is that when I am typing the cursor keeps skipping to the left again and again. It rarely happens when I type fast. Please help. What I feel is that some keyboard driver may be corrupt. Please help.

Sandeep Kumar

 See if it happens when you press the keys nearest to the arrow buttons. Also ensure that you're not touching the trackpad accidentally with your palm and moving the cursor by mistake - it's a common problem. The easiest way to test this is to see if you have a button to turn off the trackpad, and do so. Alternatively you can even look for the option in Control Panel. Then try typing at fast speeds and see if the problem recurs. If it's happening when you use letters such

as L, K, M or N, then there's something wrong with your hardware, and you might need to change the keyboard layer of the laptop.

Here to serve you

I want to know if I can setup a mail server or web server in Linux and make it live, i.e. i can go live using my private system. I have a domain name for myself.

Saurav Singh

 Yes you can, that is how any web sites is hosted. However you will need a static IP. You might not have one if you connect to the internet using a regular internet connection. You can opt for services such as <http://www.no-ip.com/> or <http://www.dyndns.com/> which map a dynamic IP to a host name.

You will be better off buying hosting unless you are using this server for small experiments / testing. In those cases you need not even map them to a domain name.

Outdated ISP

I just installed Ubuntu 11.04 with my Windows. After installation I found that the login software provided by Sify Broadband for Linux does not work on Ubuntu 11.04 as Ubuntu comes with a newer version of openssl but Sify login software requires openssl0.9.7-0.9.7c-52922cl.386 as one of its requirements and I can't downgrade to this version (Don't know why Ubuntu is not doing this) so that means my Sify login software does not work on the new Ubuntu 11.04 and so I can't access my internet on it.

Can you please check this problem and tell me if there is any way around this?

I've included the download link for the Sify dialer.

Ashmeet Singh

 You could alternate dialers such as this one: <http://bit.ly/dialerdown>. Sify is using an obsolete version of openssl and Ubuntu cannot and should not support such outdated version due to security issues. Complain to Sify.

Need a distro

I need a Linux Live CD which can run all normal Unix commands with vi, grep, cut, sort, sed, awk etc. + AWK and Shell programming. Secondly, I need it to compile C, C++ programs and Java programs also. Thirdly, I need it should open or create word documents, spreadsheets, presentations, gimp photos etc. Lastly, I need it to access fully all the existing windows partitions with both Read+Write+Execute. I have searched with my limited capabilities and found only Knoppix 6.4.4 live CD have all my requirements, although Ubuntu 10.10 also fullfills some of my requirements (Java compiler, gimp don't exist, can't create executable files on Vista partitions, hugely memory hungry). Can you suggest me some more Linux Live CD distros which can fullfil all of my requirements. If you advice me then it will be very much helpfull to me and my hundreds of students of computer science.

Roubhya Shankar Aluni

 The JDK is a rare sight on live CDs, so one of the readymade solutions might not cut it for you. Why not roll out your own customized live CD?

For this you could go with <http://porteus.org/> a Linux distro designed for portability. You can install modules for any applications that dont come by default. Another option is SUSE Studio, which is an online tool for creating your own Linux distros. You can pick the repositories and software selection, and it will create a live disk image for you that you. You can even add your own branding to this for better effect.